With AWS, you can achieve a linear relationship between traffic and costs. And other opportunities await you with this pricing model.

1.4.3 Pay-per-use opportunities

The AWS pay-per-use pricing model creates new opportunities. For example, the barrier for starting a new project is lowered, because you no longer need to invest in infrastructure up front. You can start virtual machines on demand and pay only per second of usage. You can stop using those virtual machines whenever you like, and you no longer have to pay for them. You don’t need to make an upfront commitment regarding how much storage you’ll use.

Another example: a big virtual machine costs exactly as much as two smaller ones with the same capacity. Thus, you can divide your systems into smaller parts, because the cost is the same. This makes fault tolerance affordable not only for big companies but also for smaller budgets.

1.5 Comparing alternatives

AWS isn’t the only cloud computing provider. Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud Platform (GCP) are major players as well. The three major cloud providers share a lot in common. They all have the following:

- A worldwide infrastructure that provides computing, networking, and storage capabilities
- An IaaS offering that provides virtual machines on-demand: Amazon EC2, Azure Virtual Machines, Google Compute Engine